We're Going to be Friends

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General Audiences

Archive Warning:
No Archive Warnings Apply

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

Relationship:
Adora & Catra (She-Ra)

Characters:
Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), He-Man | Adam, Marlena (He-Man), Randor (He-Man)

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Fluff, Slice of Life, Adora (She-Ra) and He-Man | Adam are Siblings, Football | Soccer, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Alternate Universe - Football, First Meetings, Language Barrier, Friendship, Slight Panic Attack, Kid Fic, Title From a The White Stripes Song

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by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

Adora is thirteen. She's thirteen and leaving her family behind to pursue her dream of becoming a professional soccer player by joining the academy of FC Horde. She's barely left Eternia and is already feeling homesick. While on the plane for Etheria, she gets seated next to someone else her age wearing FC Horde gear... Assuming that she is one of her new teammates, she tries to talk to the girl, only they apparently don't even speak the same language...

(Or Adora and Catra's first meeting in the professional soccer AU that I'm writing)

Notes

Alright, awhile back, I posted a soccer AU titled "Just a Soccer AU". After thinking about the concept more though, I decided to delete it and rewrite it. Right now, the new title is "Stadium Lights and Life", though that might change (we'll see). It's going to be a modern AU where Adora and Catra are professional soccer players though and trying to navigate life. I'm not sure when I will be publishing it, hopefully at the end of this month or early December but if you like this story, then bookmark the series!

Also a special thank you to CaliJester for beta-reading this! Thank you!

See the end of the work for more notes

“You’re going to do great!”

The words were spoken softly, in a whisper that conveyed the care and love that a mother could provide. Adora clung to her mom as those words were whispered to her, buried deep in her comforting embrace. She breathed in the floral and jasmine perfume, a familiar scent, a staple throughout her childhood.

Adora didn’t say anything back. She felt like she should but she was afraid. She was terrified that if she spoke, the dam she had been desperately trying to hold back since this morning would finally break.

Homesickness. She hadn’t thought about how much she would miss everything and everyone. Not until she walked downstairs early that morning and saw the bags she had packed the night before sitting by the front door. Waiting. It was at that moment, it had actually dawned on her. This was a good opportunity for her. She was excited about it. She couldn’t wait to travel to Etheria and play for FC Horde’s academy.

She spent weeks dreaming of the day she would finally board that plane, the day she would arrive in Etheria, the day she would step foot onto the famed training grounds of FC Horde (and maybe eventually onto the field of the legendary Fright Zone Stadium). She didn’t think about everything (and everyone) she would leave behind, not until this morning that is.

Despite her efforts, tears began to fill the corner of her eyes. She hurriedly blinked them away. She fought back the sob that was threatening to come out. She didn’t want them to see her like this. She wanted to prove to her family that *she* was ready. She *had* to prove to them that she was ready.

She was only thirteen and yet she was already considered a football prodigy. Many football experts in Eternia constantly drew comparisons between her and Eternia’s most famous player, Mara She-Ra.

The twenty-eight year-old star was her hero. She had been, ever since Adora watched her play in a friendly game for the Eternian National Team. She saw a few games on TV as a young child, but her love for the game exploded after her father and grandmother took her and her twin brother Adam to their first game. The match was a friendly between Eternia and Etheria.

There was no trophy on the line for either team, so tickets for friendly matches were typically cheaper. The games were mostly played to give players a chance to represent their home country, build chemistry between the players, and even give fans a chance to see the team live, who might not otherwise have a chance to watch them in-person. Her dad bought the tickets as soon as they went on sale, wanting to share his love of the sport with his children. The game wasn't nearby. They had to take an hour-long train ride.

Seeing it all in-person was different. The stadium, known fondly as the Crystal Castle, was ancient. It hosted numerous tournaments in the past, including a few World Cup games. Her first glimpse of the Crystal Castle came while they were still on the train. It was large. It was a bit intimidating.

The crowd was large, at times it could be hard to navigate around the stadium. It was noisy, she could barely hear her family. Adam hadn't enjoyed it. Growing up, her and Adam were often similar. Because Adam hated it, their father thought she would too. Maybe she should have but she ended up loving it. The way the crowd cheered loudly for each and every player who wore the iconic light blue of Eternia, listening to the crowds as they chanted in support of their team, hearing a band play their instruments, there was just something about the atmosphere. There was something about that she fell in love with.

Watching the players she saw on TV live… That only fueled her love for the game even more. Eternia had many good players. They played an exciting, attacking style of football. As soon as she watched She-Ra touch the ball and dribble through several

defenders though, she knew then, without a doubt, which player she wanted to be like.

She-Ra wasn't known for scoring goals. She scored a lot. Her skillset wasn't just limited to scoring though. She had an uncanny ability to know *where* she needed to be and *when*. She was the current leader in assists for Eternia. Her passing was considered to be the best in the world (and maybe ever). After that game, Adora began to spend hours outside practicing, often alone.

She was still being held tightly by her mother. Her father and twin brother standing just a few feet behind them, patiently (or in Adam's case impatiently), waiting for their turn to say goodbye. Her back was to them right now, so she at least knew that none of them had seen the few tears that did fall. She ignored the fact that some of them had fallen on her mom's shoulder and hoped that she would too.

She needed her family to know that she didn't have any worries or any regrets about this decision. She knew that they would be here, waiting for her *eventual* return. It would probably be a few months before she returned though and even then it would only be for a couple of weeks. According to their person-of-contact in FC Horde, academy players were permitted to return home for a couple of weeks during the short winter break. School would also be on break during that time, so she wouldn't be missing any classes.

Leaving wasn't an easy decision. Her parents had many, sometimes very heated, discussions about it. More than once, Adora and Adam would listen, taking turns pressing an ear against the closed door of their parents' bedroom, listening with dread as they argued about whether or not to let Adora go.

Scouts had started coming from all over the world. Some of Eternia's larger clubs had been keeping a close eye on her, some had even asked her if she would consider joining their academy teams. Unfortunately, the fee to play for them was too high, at least it was at this point in time. Older players, usually those

around sixteen or seventeen (or sometimes even fifteen but that was rare) could get a scholarship from the club and play for free. Providing a scholarship for a thirteen-year-old was more risky though. Plus, there was the issue of housing when it came to the clubs that were hours away.

FC Horde had offered a scholarship, free schooling, housing (a host family), free training gear… It was too good of an offer to refuse. They were also FC Horde, one of the biggest names in football. The only team who *could* rival them in popularity would be the Bright Moon Alliance. Supposedly they were supposed to send a scout out to one of Adora's games but no one could ever recall seeing one.

Their mother was anxious about Adora going away. She would be nervous about either of her children leaving. She hated the idea of Adora being two hours away playing for some club in Eternia. The prospect of her only daughter going halfway across the world, to a country where they didn't have any family or friends around… Well, that possibility had sent her into an anxiety-induced spiral.

Their father was concerned too but he hid it much better. He always had. It was something that their mom both hated and loved about him. He knew the opportunity was too good for Adora to pass up on so easily. He knew about her dream of playing professionally one day and he wanted to do everything in his power to help her achieve her dreams. When the Eternian scouts started coming and there were more serious discussions about her playing at a higher level, he started working more hours, trying to bring in more money so they could afford to let her play for one of those clubs.

Eventually, after many late-night discussions, they both decided the ultimate decision should be hers and so they all sat down one night to have a family discussion. It was mostly Randor, her father, who talked. He wanted to be sure that she understood the benefits but also the downside of leaving and going to Etheria. Unfortunately, they couldn't go with her, so she would be alone, something that hadn't hit her until this morning.

Marlena, her mother, was mostly quiet during the family meeting. Adam was too. In thirteen years, the two of them had been inseparable. Sure, they didn't do everything together, she became more focused on playing football, while he was more focused on art now. Most of their free time was spent together though and Adam would often hang out with her while practicing on the field near their house, content to draw whenever she didn't try to drag him into helping her train.

Ever since that night… Ever since her bright blue eyes had lit up and without hesitation, exclaimed that she was ready to join FC Horde, she felt a slight rift between her and Adam. She hated it.

Despite the early hours, the Eternian International Airport was already busy. All around the family, travelers hurried along. It was noisy too, as suitcases of all colors were rolled across the massive airport. Some people chatted loudly on their cellphones, either unaware or uncaring of anyone who could overhear their conversations.

They already checked Adora's suitcase in, it was one of the first things they had done when they arrived. She had her carry-on bag on the ground beside her. It was one of the many items FC Horde had sent over in preparation for her impending flight. It was a black backpack, with the emblem of her new team patched on its front. In addition to the bag, she also got several sets of training and travel wear, all adorned with their emblem.

The flight was also paid for by the club. Unfortunately, there would be a two-hour layover at another airport. Still, none of them could complain since it was a free flight.

Today, Adora was wearing the black sweatpants and gray hoodie that the Horde sent over. They had also sent over a couple of baseball caps as well, one black and one in their well-known red and white color scheme. She hadn't opted to wear those today. Instead, the black cap was attached to the top handle of her new backpack, and the red cap was tucked safely inside her suitcase.

Marlena gave her one more tight squeeze and then pulled away, allowing for Randor his turn to say goodbye. He gave her a quick hug, whispering to her how proud he was of her. He told her that repeatedly over the last few weeks. He kept telling her how excited he was for her and how this was a great opportunity.

Despite how reassuring he tried to sound though, Adora could still hear some of the worry in his voice and she could occasionally see the concern in his eyes whenever they would excitedly talk about everything she would see in Etheria.

Adam, looked to be on the verge of tears. Adora tried to avoid his gaze as Randor now pulled away. His goodbye had been brief, no doubt to give Marlena and Adam more time. Adora glanced at her bag on the floor. If she saw Adam, she would start crying herself. She couldn't cry. She needed to be strong for them. Saying goodbye to her parents had been hard but saying goodbye to Adam? She knew that was going to be the hardest goodbye.

When they were younger, their parents would try to do separate trips and "fun things" with them, to help them get used to eventually not being together all the time. It was also good for bonding (or so they said). Randor would usually take Adam away for a couple of days for a camping trip, while Adora and Marlena would spend the time doing whatever Adora wanted to do. Sometimes they would switch and Adora would go camping, while Adam stayed home and picked out fun activities to do. Unfortunately, as the bills got bigger and schedules tighter, those special days became fewer and soon stopped altogether.

Most of Adora's free time was now spent on a soccer field. She would spend hours during the week just practicing. She had games, she had training with her team, but for some reason, it never felt like enough. There was a field right by their house, across the street to be exact. It was her favorite spot to be. The field could be seen from her bedroom window and whenever it was time for her to go home, all Marlena had to do was step out onto the front porch and yell.

It hit her again and she frowned. She wasn't going to be close enough for her mom to just step outside and spot her. She wouldn't be on the same street as her childhood home. She wouldn't even be in the same country as her family. Everyone and everything she knew and loved would be here and she would be… Well, she would have a whole ocean between her and everything familiar. At first, that thought had been exciting but now.. Now it was scaring her.

As soon as Randor pulled away, Adam rushed forward and immediately wrapped her in a bear-hug, briefly lifting her off the ground, despite their almost identical height. She hugged back just as fiercely, trying desperately to keep her tears at bay. She could hear her brother sniffling and fighting back a sob. Tears began to stream down her own face. She hated this. She wished that they could go with her to Etheria but it just wasn't feasible. She wondered for a moment if maybe she was making a mistake. She pushed that thought out of her head, this was too great of an opportunity for her to pass up.

"Alright, son, time to go," Randor said gently, putting a hand on Adam's shoulder. He released her reluctantly. He only managed to lift her a couple of inches, so the drop wasn't sudden. Adora instantly regretted looking at his face as his eyes were red and she could see the tears still visibly gathering in them.

"Be sure to video call us when you get to Etheria," her mother instructed gently, "Text us when you get to Halfmoon, please!"

Adora nodded and replied softly, "Yes."

All last week, she felt good about this decision. She was excited! She felt brave(italic), but now that the moment was here, she suddenly felt very small and very afraid. She didn't want them to know though, so she quickly turned her back to them and hurried to the security line. She tried to avoid glancing back at her family, if she looked at them, she might lose the nerve to do this.

FC Horde was one of the biggest clubs in the world. If they thought you were good enough for their academy team, especially if they were willing to give you a *scholarship* to play for them, then it would be silly to turn them down. In addition to a clear path to becoming a professional. Their reputation was so great that even if she didn't go pro, she still had a good chance of earning a scholarship with a university, either way, her future should be secured.

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The flight to Halfmoon was long, about thirteen hours long, and uneventful. Trying to sleep was impossible, no matter how hard she tried. She tried to think of everything she had to look forward to, of everything waiting for her in Etheria but her thoughts kept drifting back to Eternia, back to her family, back *home*.
She spent weeks imagining what her new team would be like, how Etheria would be. She spent weeks fantasizing about the day she would actually sign her first professional contract and play in front of rabid crowds in the Fright Zone. She imagined what it would be like to eventually wear the familiar light blue shirt of the Eternian National Team and play alongside her hero Mara… She had spent so many days thinking and imagining what the future *could* hold that until this morning, she hadn't even considered what she was leaving behind, or *who* she was leaving behind…

Maybe she should have stayed in Eternia. She frowned at that thought, her mind now replaying the different choices she could have made. She could have signed professionally for a team back home, right? She was getting noticed by plenty of academy teams back in Eternia. Plenty of players got their start in their home countries. But there was the issue of money… Still, she could have waited until she was sixteen or even seventeen to play for an academy team, right?

Mara left home when she was about her age. Actually, Mara had been a whole year younger, just twelve years old when she left behind Eternia to follow her dream. Adora spared a glance at her backpack, securely on her lap. She brought a few of her *prized*

possessions, among them her very first Eternian National Team jersey, a gift from her grandmother when she was about five or maybe six years old. It bore the name of the Eternian legend and her now iconic number ten. She didn't dare put it in her suitcase, terrified that she would be one of the unlucky people to have their luggage lost. She had a few other Eternian jerseys, but this one... This one was special. It was her first. It didn't fit, not anymore at least, but she still treasured it.

If Mara could leave Eternia… If Mara could leave behind everything she knew and loved, then she could too. One day, she was going to help the legendary She-Ra win a World Cup for their country. To do that, she needed to be better. She needed to learn everything she could. She needed to push herself to her limits. One day, she would step out onto the field, in the blue of Eternia, and her family would be out in the crowd, cheering her and the rest of Eternia on… One day…

She yawned. There were six hours left on the flight until she arrived at Halfmoon. Her eyes began to drift close, maybe she could sleep some. She was tired and her mind was slowly beginning to quiet itself…

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The layover was set to be two hours long. Halfmoon Airport was very different from Eternia's. It was smaller, but it was also a smaller country. Most of the country was actually located deep inside some caves near Etheria, the airport was one of the few areas outside that was still considered to be part of the country. The signs were also primarily in another language, with a few other languages translating under it, in smaller but still visible writing. Adora recognized one of the languages and was quickly able to find the gate for the next flight. Flight 3033.

As soon as she got to the waiting area, she took her phone out and texted her family, letting them know that she arrived safely and would soon be boarding the next flight. Immediately, her family responded and she spent the next hour just messaging

with them back and forth. She was so engrossed in the chat that she only vaguely noticed that someone now sat next to her. They were wearing clothes similar to hers. Out of the corner of her eye, Adora noticed the FC Horde symbol on the newcomer's hoodie and sweatpants. Team-issued travel gear.

The newcomer glanced at her curiously, clearly recognizing the Horde logo on her own hoodie. The newcomer was a magicat. She looked to be about Adora's age. Her hair was full and almost wild-looking, it reminded Adora of a lion's mane. On her lap, the girl had a black backpack similar to Adora's.

Adora flashed the newcomer a quick smile and then her full attention returned to her phone. Eventually, the family group chat died down, her father had to return to work, and her mom had to go back to whatever she was doing. Usually her mom would be at work, but she took the day off. Adam continued to message her though, sending her random pictures or videos he found online that he thought she might like.

Soon enough, it was time for her to board the next flight. She quickly sent a "boarding again, talk when I land" message to her family and quickly turned her phone off. She hurriedly picked her backup up off the ground and scrambled to her feet.

Despite the fact that she had plenty of time to board (they had only just called for boarding after all), she felt as though she was in a rush and so she almost sprinted to the gate, slowing only when the attendant at the desk, a young, gray magicat man glared at her.

The Attendant's tail twitched behind him irritatedly, and his brows furrowed. Adora gave him a sheepish smile and slowed to a walk. The girl from before followed her wordlessly. Out of the corner of her eye though, Adora could have sworn that she saw the girl stick her tongue out at the attendant as they both walked past him.

Adora glanced down at her ticket and made her way to her seat, trying to carefully maneuver around the other people already on the plane. She mumbled a quick "sorry" whenever she bumped into someone, which was unfortunately often. Most didn't even glance in her direction, understanding that it was a tight fit at the moment as everyone shuffled to their seats. A few glared at her and she tried to avoid the angry looks, averting her eyes and hurrying (as much as she could) to her seat. The girl from before followed closely the whole time but didn't say a word.

Eventually, Adora found her seat and immediately plopped into it. She held her bag close to herself on her lap. The girl stopped by the row of seats Adora was at and glanced at the paper ticket in her hands. After a moment she slid in, sitting next to Adora. She still said nothing though.

Adora glanced at her. The flight itself was about three hours, but she wasn't sure how long it would take for the plane to take off. She was wide awake now and a three-hour flight didn't exactly sound like a good time to nap, at least to her it didn't. The closer she got to Etheria, the more awake (and anxious) she became, so even if she wanted to sleep, she doubted that she could.

She glanced at the girl next to her. She was wearing the same Horde-issued clothes, even the color scheme was the same, gray hoodie and black sweatpants. She assumed that this girl was going to be one of her new teammates. If she was, it would be nice to get to know her now, she looked to be the same age as her, so more than likely they would be playing in the same age-bracket. She gave the girl a smile and reached her hand out to introduce herself, one arm still tightly holding the carry-on in her lap, she didn't want it to accidentally fall over and have to struggle to pick it back up in the tight fit.

"Hi! I'm Adora! What's your name?" She greeted enthusiastically, a large smile on her face like she always had when meeting someone new.

The girl stared at her hand. Like Adora, she kept her carry-on on her lap, hugging it against herself. She didn't take Adora's hand though, so after an awkward moment, Adora pulled her hand back and rested it on the top of her bag. *Maybe the girl wasn't a hand shaker?* she thought. She knew that not everyone was, after all. A few of her teammates on her old team (internally, she grimaced at the thought of calling the team she had played with for years her *old*) hated to shake hands.

She and this new girl could still talk though. She waited but the girl didn't say anything, instead her mismatched eyes were watching her curiously. Instead of pressuring her for her name, Adora decided to ask something else, although she was pretty sure that she knew the answer. She hoped that the question would get the girl to open up and talk.

"So… Are you joining the Horde academy too?"

The girl still didn't reply. At least, she didn't with words. She held up her index finger instead, and quickly unzipped her bag. She immediately began to shuffle everything around, hurriedly searching for something in particular it seemed. After a bit, she triumphantly pulled her phone out of the bag, a bright smile now on her face. She hit the side button and the screen lit up. She searched through her phone. Adora looked away, assuming that the girl had no interest in talking to her or even acknowledging her existence. She was slightly bummed out about that, it would have been nice to know at least one person before landing in Etheria.

After a moment though, she felt someone tap her shoulder and she glanced at the girl, who excitedly showed her the app she was looking for. It was a translator app. Adora then realized that the girl probably didn't understand her. She then remembered the signs in the airport and how they were primarily in another language. She wanted to mentally slap herself. She couldn't remember ever learning about Halfmoon in school. Eventually, she would take more in-depth courses on geography, but what she knew right now was limited to Eternia and Etheria.

The girl clicked on the translator app and quickly typed something in. Adora couldn't read the language. She noted that it was already set to translate into Eternian though. Etheria spoke Eternian. To both girls disappointed though, they were immediately greeted with the message: *Can't translate. Check your network connection and try again.*

The girl scowled. Adora frowned. It was a good idea. Unfortunately, neither of them seemed to remember that they needed an internet connection for the app to work. The girl just about threw her phone back into her bag and huffed in annoyance. Her ears now flat against her head.

Adora looked away. The girl was quiet. After a bit though, the girl spoke. She said something, Adora couldn't understand what she said but glanced at the girl. The girl gave up whatever she was saying or maybe asking and she instead pointed to the logo on her hoodie and said slowly, "Horde."

Adora nodded and repeated, "Yeah. Horde."

The girl smiled. She then pointed at herself, making sure that she and Adora maintained eye-contact and said very slowly, "Catra."

Catra. What did that…? It then dawned on Adora, that must be the girl's name. So Adora repeated it, slowly so she would be sure that she didn't mess it up, "Catra?"

The girl nodded again, pointed at herself then said it once more. Adora nodded back and repeated more confidently, "Catra."

The girl nodded, a bright smile now on her face. She then pointed at Adora and said something. She then recognized it as the same phrase from before. She realized that the girl must be asking for her name.

"Adora," she answered, trying to say it as slowly and clearly as the girl had said her own name just moments before.

“Adora,” Catra repeated, she sounded more confident than Adora did when she first tried to say Catra’s name.

Adora nodded and gave a thumbs-up. Catra smiled at her and repeated the name once more but quieter, as if she was trying to commit it to memory. There was silence between them now. It took a bit but soon the plane took off and they were in the air. Adora turned the screen in front of her on, maybe there would be a good movie or something to help fill the time. She scrolled through, the options were very slim though. She eventually just settled on the GPS screen, at least she would know how long until they arrived.

She leaned back into her seat. She wished that knew Halfmoon’s language, or that the translator app would have worked. It would have been nice to visit with Catra during the flight, maybe even make a new friend before landing somewhere new. Somewhere unfamiliar… Her thoughts drifted back home once more.

The realization that she was going to be somewhere where she didn’t know anything hit hard now. Tears slowly welled up in her eyes. There was a pit in her stomach now and she clenched her hands, opening and closing them as they began to feel *weird*... *tingly* almost. She didn’t notice that her new teammate was glancing at her or the way that Catra’s brows furrowed in her concern.

Catra glanced away and began to dig through her bag again. She would occasionally stop and glance at Adora, as if she was checking that she was okay. The blonde paid her no mind, her misty gaze on the screen in front of her, as if she was trying to focus on the current route the plane was taking.

Catra continued to dig through her pack, pushing aside the random items inside until she finally found what she was searching for. A big smile flashed across her face as she found it and she pulled out a magazine. After tapping Adora on the shoulder once more, she set it on the armrest between them

The magazine's cover was primarily red with the current year and the words "World Cup" in yellow, bubble letters. Several soccer players, all in different colored uniforms flooded the cover as well. Angella Moon (a defensive midfielder from Etheria, probably in her last World Cup), Huntara Crim (a young, promising striker from the small country of the Crimson Waste), Entrapa Saber (Etheria's goalkeeper)...

Adora immediately recognized several of the players on the cover but one drew her attention the most… Mara She-Ra, dressed in the familiar blue Eternian colors. Near the image of Mara was a magicat player, dressed in the yellow and black uniform of the Halfmoon National Team, Kiara King. She was considered to be Mara's rival. The two players had long been thought of as the best players in the world.

Catra pushed the magazine closer to Adora and glanced at her. It almost looked as though she was asking her something… Not sure what though, Adora took a guess and held the magazine in place on the armrest. Catra then quickly returned to her bag and began to dig around in it once more. Adora glanced at her, curious at what her new teammate would bring out next. After a moment, she pulled out a shirt… no, not a shirt, she realized… a jersey. It was black and yellow, just like the one Kiara was wearing.

Catra looked at the jersey fondly and carefully unfolded it. She turned it over so that the name and number were proudly shown on it: King 7. Adora grinned and then with her free hand, unzipped her bag and dug through her bag one-handed. She spotted the familiar blue and gingerly pulled the jersey out.

She tried to unfold the jersey but it was harder to do one-handed. Catra set her jersey on top of her bag and put a hand on the magazine to keep it in place for Adora. Adora flashed her a "thank you" smile and quickly but carefully unfolded the jersey to show off the name on the back: She-Ra 10.

After a bit, both girls carefully folded the jerseys back up, careful to not crease the name or number on the back. They each took a

turn holding the magazine so it didn't fall. After putting their jerseys back in their respective bags and zipping the bags closed, the two girls began to flip through the magazine. Unfortunately for Adora, the interviews were in Halfmoon's language, but she enjoyed the pictures.

Soon enough they were in Etheria. They stayed together as they departed the plane. From the itinerary Adora received, a representative from the Horde would greet her at the airport; she assumed that the same was for Catra as well. Supposedly she would also meet her host family at the Horde's facilities. She hoped that Catra's host family would be near hers. Hopefully, now that they had an internet connection, they could use the translator app to talk. Maybe she could even try to learn some of Halfmoon's language.

As soon they grabbed their luggage, Adora remembered her family. She pulled out her phone and sent them a quick text. She knew her mom wanted to video message but maybe her mother could wait until she got the host family… Catra took that moment to message on her phone as well.

The two of them walked together. Adora was still nervous. Somehow though, Catra's presence was already making it easier. As they made their way to arrivals, Catra began to type one-handed on her phone. After a beat, she moved her phone in Adora's field of vision. It was a short message: "*Hey Adora*".

Adora smiled and then pulled out her phone again. She stopped, and Catra halted soon after, staring at her curiously. Adora searched through the app store quickly for a translator app and downloaded the first one she saw. She clicked on it and immediately set to getting to translate Eternian to… what… She remembered then that she still wasn't sure what Halfmoon's official language was. She glanced at Catra and smiled sheepishly. Hopefully, she wouldn't think of her as too much of an idiot.

"Um… Can you…?" She handed her phone to Catra. The other girl took it and after a second returned it. Adora glanced at the

language and committed the name to memory. She then typed a return message and handed the phone back to Catra: "*Hey, Catra*".

The two of them finally made it to arrivals. Just as the itinerary said, there was someone waiting for them. A woman. She was dressed in a red polo with the Horde logo on the chest. A red hat brandishing the brand was her head. She was on her phone, blissfully unaware that the two girls had arrived. Tucked up under the woman's arm was a white poster board, Adora and Catra could vaguely make out two names on there: the first name Adora noticed was the end of her last name, …kull. Below her name, she saw the last few letters of another name: …luth.

Adora and Catra walked up to her and waited. The woman was still focused on her phone though. Adora thought for a moment about saying something. She assumed that this the woman who was supposed to meet them. She clearly had on Horde clothes. She also had the poster board that she *knew* had her last name on it. She was sure that the other last name must be Catra's. Adora opened her mouth to say a quiet and respectful *excuse me*, before she could though, Catra cleared her throat. She cleared it *loudly*, which gained the woman's attention. She startled, the poster board falling out from under her arms. It landed face down, so Adora still didn't catch Catra's last name.

The woman quickly apologized and led them out of the airport. She helped them get their luggage into a car. The car was completely decorated in the Horde's logo. Their emblem adorned the hood and the side of the car had pictures of some of the players. After their luggage was securely placed inside, Adora and Catra slid into the back of the car, while the woman got behind the wheel. Adora glanced out the window. The city was big. Far bigger than her hometown in Eternia. In the distance, she could spot the famous Whispering Woods. She was still nervous. She knew that this was the right decision though. No matter what, even if she didn't become a professional player, maybe her father was right and just the experience would be good for her.

End Notes

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